strife of Cain and Abel is between them. When government is weak, the nomad raids into the sown. Several times historically in Palestine he has conquered and settled. His goats and his camels are the enemies of the farmer. They break into gardens, eat the branches of trees, despoil the rocky land of its scanty herbage, and so cause it to erode. On the other hand, the farmer is ceaselessly engaged in an effort to extend the sown at the expense of the herdsman's pastures. He claims wells and denies ancient grazing rights. It is the wisdom of the Bible, uncommon in written history (for history is written only by the sown), that it makes Cain the farmer the murderer of Abel the herdsman. The farmer calls the nomad an Ishmael, a wild man whose hand is against every man, and therefore why should not every man's hand be against him? The farmer sets watchers on the hillside, in times of weakness he pays tribute to the nomad, and in times of extreme weakness he abandons the valleys which are too open to nomadic raids. Such has been the history of the relation of Palestine with the lands to the east for at least three thousand years.

Nomadic life has dominated the Semitic desert lands since about 1100 B.C., when the camel appears to have been first domesticated. It was a life of continuous raiding and intermittent tribal warfare, quelled only for relatively short periods by the emergence of strong regional powers. Theft of camels and trespass upon pastures were the most frequent origins of tribal wars. Robbery with violence was recognized to be legitimate by the desert, whether directed against other tribes, travelers, or settlers. The desert loved a great robber and a great fighter. Auda abu Tayi, Lawrence's collaborator, was famous for having drunk his enemy's blood and eaten his heart. Robbery was so general even in the decade before World War I that Moslems did not refrain from charging the Sherif of Mecca with conspiring with the bedouin to rob the pilgrims to Mecca and to share the booty. The bedouin lived in a constant state of war for, even if the surest guarantees of peace had been arranged with neighboring tribes, a raiding party might suddenly swoop down from 100 miles away, drive off the herds, and leave the defeated tribe to die of starvation.